



Structure of a hurricane

Winds blow in a spiral around the calm, low-pressure center, or "eye." Immediately around the eye is a dense bank of clouds—the eyewall—where the winds are strongest.

Satellite view of Hurricane Katrina

The eye is clearly visible, surrounded by a vast mass of swirling clouds.

Typhoon Tip, 1979

The largest, most intense tropical storm ever, Tip's winds reached 190 mph (305 kph); 86 deaths were recorded. It had weakened when it hit Japan.

Bhola Cyclone, 1970

This storm of unknown intensity caused up to 500,000 deaths in what is now Bangladesh.

Cyclone Idai, 2019

This Category 2 storm made landfall near Beira, Mozambique, causing severe flooding and over 1,000 deaths.

Cyclone Marcus, 2018

Marcus was the strongest tropical cyclone to hit Darwin, Australia, since 1974. It caused an estimated \$75 million worth of damage.

Cyclone Winston, 2016

Category 5 Winston was the most intense tropical storm ever recorded in the Southern Hemisphere, leaving 44 dead and tens of thousands homeless.

Hurricanes are tropical cyclones—swirling storms that form at sea in tropical regions. Their deadliest feature, causing 90 percent of deaths, is the storm surge, when winds force huge waves ashore that batter and flood the coast.